

Android performance boosts

Android 2.2 claims to be 450 per cent improvement over the older 2.1

W7 Mobile RC1

Screenshots of the nearly finalised version appear online

rotation of screen. However, we found that these accelerometer sensors aren't very accurate and sometimes rotate the display without user input. It has two dedicated gaming keys above the screen. The keypad keys require the user to press along the dotted markings on the keypad. Any slight deviation from the dotted markings while pressing the keys will not register the input provided by the user. The keypad layout lacks beveling as well as optimal spacing, hindering the finger movements while typing. But, this model lost out by a huge margin in ergonomics.

The Verdict:

The Yari lives upto its tag of multimedia and gaming phone. It also impressed us with the abundant manual camera settings it offers to tinker with. However, its performance in the photo/video capture test was too ordinary. It performed moderately in the call clarity and signal reception test. Overall, it failed to impress in any of the key tests.

Nokia 5800 XpressMusic

It has a well sculpted body frame, encased in hard plastic with a hint of glossy brown finish. The body contours are well rounded, although a little on the thicker side, the phone grips well owing to its matte-finished back.

The volume/zoom controls, keylock and camera buttons are conveniently placed on one side and the access to the SIM card slot is strangely and inconveniently concealed below the battery compartment. The Nokia 5800 XpressMusic lost out on user-friendliness and also on the ergonomics as a whole, due to lack of hardware keypad as



Nokia 5800 XpressMusic

was the case with Sony Ericsson's Vivaz. The touchscreen is decent, considering the fact that it is resistive. Navigating around the phone is not a problem due to the large finger friendly interface of the phone but for finer usage, like handwriting or click small links, the stylus is provided to do the job.

The Verdict:

Nokia XpressMusic 5800 is an excellent music phone and more, due to its Symbian roots and wide application base. It truly stole the limelight with its sublime performance in the loudspeaker audio clarity and bundled earphones quality test scoring 9 on 10 in each category. It delivered excellent phone earpiece volume and handsfree clarity in the signal reception and call clarity test. It clearly outperformed its nearest rivals: Sony Ericsson Yari, LG GW550, Samsung Monte S5620, Samsung Corby Pro B5310 and LG GT505 running close on the heels of Nokia 6700 in the overall rating for the category. So, considering the price to features and price to performance ratio, it is a good multimedia

phone for an estimated price tag of about Rs. 15,600.

Nokia 6700 Classic

The Nokia 6700 Classic is targeted as a basic mid-level mobile phone with multimedia features. It has a solid all metal steel body with a thin black hard plastic lining running across the contours of the body frame and highlighting the frame of the camera lens for a stylish look.

The volume control and camera buttons are blended into the plastic lining. The microUSB port and the charging point are placed at the bottom of the phone, like most 'Classic' series phones. The front panel button layout, including a metallic D-Pad, left and right 'Selection' buttons and 'Call control' buttons, has a glossy black finish. The battery cover has a conventional slide and lock mechanism and is built out of solid shiny steel which completes the flashy look of the phone. The keypad buttons are hard to press owing to the lack of beveling and key markers but have a consistent tactile feedback. However, the user interface is well organized and exudes a very user-friendly experience.

The Verdict

The Nokia 6700 is good looking, well laid out, no-nonsense phone, but it's too shiny for our liking. It scored well in the build quality, ergonomics and keypad

design test with a solid metallic build and intuitive user interface. It had a modest outing in the Bluetooth test. However, it did extremely well in the hands-free clarity and speaker volume (on call) test sharing top honours with its cousin the Nokia 5800 and Samsung Corby Pro, racking up a score of 9 on 10 in both the tests. A good buy –if you're looking for a sleek numberpad phone.

Samsung B5310 CorbyPro

The front panel has a glossy black finish incorporating the 'select', 'call answer' and 'call disconnect' buttons. The contours of the body are well rounded to enable a comfortable grip while holding the mobile in your palm. The battery cover is coated in snow-white and contrasts well with the black coating on the front and sides.

The QWERTY keypad layout is neat with bevelled key markings. The number keys, navigation keys and special keys are marked in choco-brown colour for ease of identification and also to enhance the appealing aesthetics of the keypad.



Nokia 6700 Classic



Samsung B5310 CorbyPro